

Ryan Ott

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EXPERIENCE

Explainable AI for Multimodal Classification — BMW Group Munich, Jan 2025 - Current

Markedly improved BMW's machine learning pipeline for customer vehicle fault classification as part of a 6-month Master thesis internship. Resulted in an increase in classification accuracy with a reduction in training time, while providing novel model explanations and insights to engineers on the most important features for each fault class.

Board Member for Inclusive AI — ELLIS Amsterdam, Nov 2024 - Current

Under the European Laboratory for Learning and Intelligent Systems (ELLIS), I contribute to initiatives aimed at promoting diversity and inclusion in AI research and development. We manage funding and support for attending conferences, host panels and workshops, and provide mentorship to underrepresented groups in the field of AI.

AI for Space Standards Analysis — ESA Noordwijk, Aug 2024 - Oct 2024

Built NLP-based machine learning tools for the European Space Agency (ESA) to analyze and consolidate space mission technical standards. The tools from this project are now actively used by the ECSS (European Cooperation for Space Standardization) in its NextGen project to define the next generation of space standards.

Fintech Product Management & Technical Support — Adyen Amsterdam, Nov 2021 – Jul 2024

Coordinated the deprecation of a critical legacy feature of the online payments platform, aligning product, development and legal teams to ensure a seamless transition for merchants. Improved technical documentation by applying topic extraction and sentiment analysis to internal communications. Supported merchants and internal teams with API configuration, Python automation, and resolution of complex payment integration issues.

PUBLICATIONS

Sauter, Adrian et al. (2024). ““Studying How to Efficiently and Effectively Guide Models with Explanations” - A Reproducibility Study”. In: *Transactions on Machine Learning Research*. Presented at the 38th annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024 in Vancouver, Canada. ISSN: 2835-8856. URL: <https://openreview.net/forum?id=9ZzASCVhDF>.

PROJECTS

Investigating Visually Grounded Language Embeddings [Link to Poster](#)

Research project, probing the language embedding space of a pre-trained vision-and-language model to understand how incorporating visual information affects the language embeddings. Won 1st place at the UvA *Interpretability and Explainability in AI* conference in 2024.

EDUCATION

2023 - present	MSc Artificial Intelligence at Universiteit van Amsterdam	GPA: 8.3
2020 - 2023	BSc Artificial Intelligence at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam	GPA: 8.4

SKILLS

Languages	English (native), German (native), Dutch (native), Russian (elementary)
Technology	Python, PyTorch, Sklearn, Scipy, Numpy, Pandas, C#, Java, SQL, Git, AWS

HOBBIES

Improving at padel // cooking (especially Asian cuisine) // any and all racing (motorsports, cycling, ...)